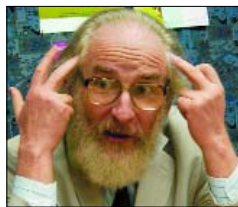
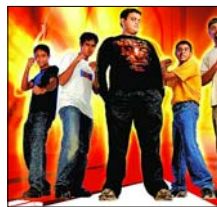




36 Louiz Banks on Technology



37 Language Onslaughts



44 The Guys at Their Game

Digital Passion

Fuelling the pursuit of technology knowledge

Lead Feature

The Man who saw Tomorrow

Reliance Infocomm chief Mukesh Ambani says the future of communication will not be just voice services; it will be high-speed data. He tells 'Digit' how he plans to deliver that dream

Sachin Kalbag

The innocuously-named National Network Operating Centre (NNOC) at Reliance Infocomm's 140-acre Dhirubhai Ambani Knowledge City in Navi Mumbai is one of the 20-odd, post-modern buildings that the complex houses. Large Samsung plasma monitors line the large hallway with promotional films reminiscent of the subliminal messages delivered in George Orwell's 1984, interspersed with wall-mounted displays of the company's history, its achievements, its technologies, a few phone models, a Reliance

Web World, a Java Green coffee outlet—you get the picture. A few steps later, the well-appointed, well-rehearsed hostess in a well-starched sari takes you through a motion-activated door into what looks like an aerobridge. On either side of the passageway are James Bond-like glass walls that give you a bird's eye-view into a revolution.

It is mostly quiet here, and the engineers downstairs look at large LCD video walls—ones that allow them to monitor every single point on the Reliance network (see box 'What is NNOC All About?' on Page 28).

They seem to work with almost NASA-like efficiency to run India's largest cellular phone service. It is so efficient it gets boring after a while; suppressing a yawn becomes tough.

The Man

Mukesh Ambani, Chairman and Managing Director, Reliance Infocomm, would

Imaging: Anil Deshmukh

